

DAY 15

Project Status Reporting & RAID Log

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the purpose of project status reports and who reads them
- Learn the RAG status system: Red, Amber, Green and when to use each
- Understand RAID log: Risks, Assumptions, Issues, Dependencies
- Learn how to present bad news to stakeholders without losing their trust
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "Project status report template"
 - "RAG status project management"
 - "RAID log explained"
 - "How to present bad news to stakeholders"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - [ProjectManager.com](https://www.projectmanager.com)
 - PM Majik
 - PMC Lounge

Tasks:

- Study the anatomy of a project status report — Project Summary, Current Status (RAG), Milestone Progress, Accomplishments This Period, Planned for Next Period, Issues and Risks, Budget Status, and Key Decisions Needed
- Learn the RAID log in detail — Risks are future threats, Assumptions are things you believe to be true but have not confirmed, Issues are current problems, and Dependencies are things outside your control that your project relies on — a PM who does not maintain a RAID log is flying blind
- Write a project status report for the Expense Tracker project at the end of a simulated Sprint 2 — the project is Amber status because one dependency is delayed — present the situation honestly with the impact assessment and your mitigation plan
- Write a RAID log for the Expense Tracker project with at least 3 entries per category (12 total) — each entry should have a description, owner, date raised, and current status

Deliverable

- Sprint 2 project status report
- RAID log with 12 entries
- Short note: why honest Amber/Red reporting builds more stakeholder trust than always reporting Green

Sprint 2 Project Status Report

Project Name : Expense Tracker Application

Sprint : Sprint 2

Version : 1.0

Reporting Date : 26 June 2026

Project Manager : Dhruv Gupta

1. Project Summary

The Expense Tracker project is progressing according to the overall schedule. During Sprint 2, the development team completed most of the planned user stories, including expense categories, search functionality, and monthly reports. However, one external dependency related to bank transaction API access has been delayed, preventing completion of the automatic expense import feature.

Overall project health is **Amber** because the delay may affect Sprint 3 if not resolved soon. The team has already prepared a mitigation plan to reduce the impact.

2. Current Project Status (RAG)

Area	Status	Remarks
Scope	● Green	Sprint goals mostly completed
Schedule	● Amber	API dependency delayed
Budget	● Green	Within allocated budget
Quality	● Green	Testing passed for completed features
Team Resources	● Green	Team availability is good

Overall Project Status: ● **Amber**

Reason : The external bank API integration has been delayed by the third-party provider. Core application development is continuing, but automatic expense import cannot be completed until API credentials are received.

3. Milestone Progress

Milestone	Planned Date	Current Status
User Login Module	Completed	Completed
Expense CRUD	Completed	Completed
Category Management	Sprint 2	Completed
Search & Filter	Sprint 2	Completed
Monthly Reports	Sprint 2	Completed
Bank API Integration	Sprint 2	Delayed
Dashboard Completion	Sprint 3	In Progress

4. Accomplishments This Sprint

- Completed expense category management.
- Added search and filter functionality.
- Developed monthly expense report.
- Fixed bugs reported during Sprint 1.
- Increased unit test coverage to approximately 90%.
- Improved application performance during report generation.

5. Planned for Next Sprint

- Complete bank API integration.
- Finish dashboard analytics.
- Add budget tracking feature.
- Perform integration testing.
- Conduct user acceptance testing.
- Prepare Release Candidate Version 1.0.

6. Issues and Risks

Current Issue : Third-party bank API credentials have not been delivered.

Impact : Automatic expense import feature cannot be completed.

Mitigation : Development team is using mock API data while waiting for official credentials.

Risk : Further API delays may postpone Sprint 3 deliverables.

Mitigation : Maintain regular communication with the vendor and prioritize remaining independent features.

7. Budget Status

Item	Status
Planned Budget	₹4,00,000
Actual Spend	₹2,25,000
Remaining Budget	₹1,75,000

Project remains within budget.

8. Key Decisions Needed

- Confirm revised delivery date from API vendor.
- Decide whether dashboard release should proceed without API integration if delay continues.
- Approve contingency plan for Sprint 3.

Project Health Summary

Overall Status: ● **AMBER**

The project remains healthy, with only one external dependency causing concern. No budget or quality issues currently exist, and mitigation activities are already underway.

RAID Log

ID	Category	Description	Owner	Date Raised	Current Status
R1	Risk	Third-party API delivery may be delayed	PM	22/6/26	Open
R2	Risk	User acceptance testing may identify major defects	QA Lead	23/6/26	Monitoring
R3	Risk	Scope change requests may extend project timeline	Project Sponsor	24/6/26	Monitoring
A1	Assumption	API provider will deliver credentials within one week	PM	22/6/26	Pending Confirmation
A2	Assumption	All developers remain available throughout Sprint 3	Team Lead	23/6/26	Active
A3	Assumption	Users will provide timely feedback during UAT	Business Analyst	24/6/26	Active
I1	Issue	Bank API credentials not yet received	PM	24/6/26	Open
I2	Issue	Minor UI alignment issues reported during testing	UI Developer	25/6/26	In Progress
I3	Issue	Dashboard loading is slower than expected	Backend Developer	25/6/26	Investigating
D1	Dependency	Bank API service from external vendor	Vendor	22/6/26	Delayed
D2	Dependency	Final UI approval from design team	UI Lead	23/6/26	Pending
D3	Dependency	Cloud deployment environment availability	DevOps Engineer	24/6/26	On Track

Why Honest Amber/Red Reporting Builds More Stakeholder Trust:

A good project manager reports the actual condition of the project instead of always showing Green status. Honest Amber or Red reporting helps stakeholders understand problems early, allowing them to make informed decisions and provide support before issues become critical. Hiding project risks or reporting Green when problems exist can lead to unexpected delays, increased costs, and loss of trust. Transparent reporting demonstrates professionalism, improves communication, and enables timely corrective actions. Over time, stakeholders gain confidence in a project manager who communicates both successes and challenges honestly.

Additional

How to Present Bad News to Stakeholders:

- Inform stakeholders early.
- Be honest and clear.
- Explain the impact.
- Present a solution or mitigation plan.
- Keep stakeholders updated regularly.

RAG Status System (Red, Amber, Green)

The **RAG (Red, Amber, Green)** status system is used to quickly show the overall health of a project.

Status	Meaning	When to Use
 Green	On track	Project is meeting schedule, budget, scope, and quality targets. No major risks or issues.
 Amber	At risk but manageable	Minor issues, delays, or risks exist that may affect the project but can be managed with corrective action.
 Red	Critical	Major issues threaten project success. Immediate management intervention is required to recover the project.